

ABTEEN EBRAHIMI

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[Website](#) ♦ [Google Scholar](#) ♦ [LinkedIn](#)

Boulder, CO

EDUCATION

University of Colorado Boulder

May 2026

PhD in Computer Science

Research focus: Natural Language Processing/Artificial Intelligence (NLP/AI)

University of California, Santa Cruz

2020

B.A. in Computer Science

B.A. in Computational Mathematics

Magna cum laude, with Highest Honors. GPA: 3.88

RESEARCH AND WORK EXPERIENCE

University of Colorado Boulder

Aug. 2020 - May 2026

Doctoral Researcher

- Led multilingual NLP research projects, resulting in the creation of new datasets, benchmarks, and methods. Work published at ACL, EMNLP, NAACL, and EACL.
- Organized the AmericasNLP Shared Tasks and Workshop, a multi-year collaboration leading to new evaluation resources for 13+ Indigenous languages across multiple tasks. Managed the peer review process, developed the workshop program, and allocated funds for grants and invited speakers.
- Instructor of Record for the undergraduate NLP course in Spring 2025 (70 students). Updated course curriculum, prepared lecture and course materials, and managed course staff.
- Teaching assistant for undergraduate and graduate courses in NLP, Algorithms, and Data Structures.

Google Research

Jan. - April 2024

Student Researcher

- Contributed to a novel multi-modal, multi-cultural benchmark. Designed and implemented a data pipeline to select suitable images for annotation from a corpus of 9M images.
- Developed and scaled a novel benchmark measuring temporal and geographic understanding for Gemini, which was incorporated into the internal evaluation suite.

Jelinek Summer Workshop on Speech and Language Technology

June - Aug. 2023

Researcher

- Implemented graph- and text-based representation models for 200M+ scientific documents.
- Evaluated the performance of text-based models and identified limitations stemming from non-English abstracts and titles (under review).

Natural Language and Dialogue Systems Lab

June 2018 - June 2020

Undergraduate Research Assistant

- Trained and evaluated transformer models for a data-to-text generation research project published at ACL 2019.
- Developed conversational submodules (grounding, introductions) and trained classification models for preprocessing and filtering as part of team Athena, a top-5 Amazon Alexa Prize 2019 finalist.

PUBLICATIONS

- [1] **Abteen Ebrahimi**, Adam Wiemerslage, and Katharina von der Wense. 2025. [Model-Based Ranking of Source Languages for Zero-Shot Cross-Lingual Transfer](#). EMNLP
- [2] **Abteen Ebrahimi** and Katharina von der Wense. 2024. [Zero-Shot vs. Translation-Based Cross-Lingual Transfer: The Case of Lexical Gaps](#). ACL
- [3] **Abteen Ebrahimi**, Arya D. McCarthy, Arturo Oncevay, John E. Ortega, Luis Chiruzzo, Gustavo Giménez-Lugo, Rolando Coto-Solano, and Katharina Kann. 2023b. [Meeting the Needs of Low-Resource Languages: The Value of Automatic Alignments via Pretrained Models](#). EACL
- [4] **Abteen Ebrahimi**, Manuel Mager, Arturo Oncevay, Vishrav Chaudhary, Luis Chiruzzo, Angela Fan, John Ortega, Ricardo Ramos, Annette Rios, Ivan Vladimir Meza Ruiz, Gustavo Giménez-Lugo, Elisabeth Mager, Graham Neubig, Alexis Palmer, Rolando Coto-Solano, Thang Vu, and Katharina Kann. 2022a. [AmericasNLI: Evaluating Zero-shot Natural Language Understanding of Pretrained Multilingual Models in Truly Low-resource Languages](#). ACL
- [5] **Abteen Ebrahimi** and Katharina Kann. 2021. [How to Adapt Your Pretrained Multilingual Model to 1600 Languages](#). ACL
- [6] Katharina Kann, **Abteen Ebrahimi**, Kristine Stenzel, and Alexis Palmer. 2022c. [Machine Translation Between High-resource Languages in a Language Documentation Setting](#). Field Matters
- [7] Katharina Kann, **Abteen Ebrahimi**, Joewie Koh, Shiran Dudy, and Alessandro Roncone. 2022b. [Open-domain Dialogue Generation: What We Can Do, Cannot Do, and Should Do Next](#). ConvAI
- [8] Katharina Kann, **Abteen Ebrahimi**, Manuel Mager, Arturo Oncevay, John E. Ortega, Annette Rios, Angela Fan, Ximena Gutierrez-Vasques, Luis Chiruzzo, Gustavo A. Giménez-Lugo, Ricardo Ramos, Ivan Vladimir Meza Ruiz, Elisabeth Mager, Vishrav Chaudhary, Graham Neubig, Alexis Palmer, Rolando Coto-Solano, and Ngoc Thang Vu. 2022a. [AmericasNLI: Machine Translation and Natural Language Inference Systems for Indigenous Languages of the Americas](#). *Frontiers in Artificial Intelligence*, 5
- [9] Shereen Oraby, Vrindavan Harrison, **Abteen Ebrahimi**, and Marilyn Walker. [Curate and Generate: A Corpus and Method for Joint Control of Semantics and Style in Neural NLG](#). ACL

NON-REFEREED PUBLICATIONS

- [1] Ona De Gibert, Robert Pugh, Ali Marashian, Raul Vazquez, **Abteen Ebrahimi**, Pavel Denisov, Enora Rice, Edward Gow-Smith, Juan Prieto, Melissa Robles, Rubén Manrique, Oscar Moreno, Angel Lino, Rolando Coto-Solano, Aldo Alvarez, Marvin Agüero-Torales, John E. Ortega, Luis Chiruzzo, Arturo Oncevay, Shruti Rijhwani, Katharina Von Der Wense, and Manuel Mager. 2025. [Findings of the AmericasNLP 2025 Shared Tasks on Machine Translation, Creation of Educational Material, and Translation Metrics for Indigenous Languages of the Americas](#). pages 134–152. AmericasNLP
- [2] **Abteen Ebrahimi**, Ona de Gibert, Raul Vazquez, Rolando Coto-Solano, Pavel Denisov, Robert Pugh, Manuel Mager, Arturo Oncevay, Luis Chiruzzo, Katharina von der Wense, and Shruti Rijhwani. 2024. [Findings of the AmericasNLP 2024 Shared Task on Machine Translation into Indigenous Languages](#). AmericasNLP
- [3] Luis Chiruzzo, Pavel Denisov, Alejandro Molina-Villegas, Silvia Fernandez-Sabido, Rolando Coto-Solano, Marvin Agüero-Torales, Aldo Alvarez, Samuel Canul-Yah, Lorena Hau-Ucán, **Abteen Ebrahimi**, Robert Pugh, Arturo Oncevay, Shruti Rijhwani, Katharina von der Wense, and Manuel Mager. 2024. [Findings of the AmericasNLP 2024 Shared Task on the Creation of Educational Materials for Indigenous Languages](#). AmericasNLP

- [4] **Abteen Ebrahimi**, Manuel Mager, Shruti Rijhwani, Enora Rice, Arturo Oncevay, Claudia Baltazar, María Cortés, Cynthia Montaña, John E. Ortega, Rolando Coto-solano, Hilaria Cruz, Alexis Palmer, and Katharina Kann. 2023a. [Findings of the AmericasNLP 2023 Shared Task on Machine Translation into Indigenous Languages](#). AmericasNLP
- [5] **Abteen Ebrahimi**, Manuel Mager, Adam Wiemerslage, Pavel Denisov, Arturo Oncevay, Danni Liu, Sai Koneru, Enes Yavuz Ugan, Zhaolin Li, Jan Niehues, Monica Romero, Ivan G Torre, Tanel Alumäe, Jiaming Kong, Sergey Polezhaev, Yury Belousov, Wei-Rui Chen, Peter Sullivan, Ife Adenbara, Bashar Talafha, Alcides Alcoba Inciarte, Muhammad Abdul-Mageed, Luis Chiruzzo, Rolando Coto-Solano, Hilaria Cruz, Sofía Flores-Solórzano, Aldo Andrés Alvarez López, Ivan Meza-Ruiz, John E. Ortega, Alexis Palmer, Rodolfo Joel Zevallos Salazar, Kristine Stenzel, Thang Vu, and Katharina Kann. 2022b. [Findings of the Second AmericasNLP Competition on Speech-to-Text Translation](#). In *Proceedings of the NeurIPS 2022 Competitions Track*, Volume 220 of *Proceedings of Machine Learning Research*. PMLR
- [6] Manuel Mager, Arturo Oncevay, **Abteen Ebrahimi**, John Ortega, Annette Rios, Angela Fan, Ximena Gutierrez-Vasques, Luis Chiruzzo, Gustavo Giménez-Lugo, Ricardo Ramos, Ivan Vladimir Meza Ruiz, Rolando Coto-Solano, Alexis Palmer, Elisabeth Mager-Hois, Vishrav Chaudhary, Graham Neubig, and Ngoc Thang Vu. [Findings of the AmericasNLP 2021 Shared Task on Open Machine Translation for Indigenous Languages of the Americas](#). AmericasNLP

PREPRINTS

- [1] **Abteen Ebrahimi** and Kenneth Church. 2024. [Since the Scientific Literature Is Multilingual, Our Models Should Be Too](#). *Preprint*.
- [2] Kenneth Church, Omar Alonso, Peter Vickers, Jiameng Sun, **Abteen Ebrahimi**, and Raman Chandrasekar. 2024. [Academic Article Recommendation Using Multiple Perspectives](#). *Preprint*.
- [3] Vrindavan Harrison, Juraj Juraska, Wen Cui, Lena Reed, Kevin K. Bowden, Jiaqi Wu, Brian Schwarzmann, **Abteen Ebrahimi**, Rishi Rajasekaran, Nikhil Varghese, Max Wechsler-Azen, Steve Whittaker, Jeffrey Flanigan, and Marilyn Walker. 2020. [Athena: Constructing Dialogues Dynamically with Discourse Constraints](#). *Preprint*.

SERVICE

Organizer , Workshop on NLP for Indigenous Languages of the Americas	2020-2026
Chair , NAACL Student Research Workshop	2025
Reviewer , ARR/ACL/NAACL/EMNLP/EACL/COLING	2023-2026

SKILLS

Research Expertise

Multilingual NLP · Cross-lingual transfer · Low-resource settings · LLM evaluation & benchmarking · Dataset construction · Zero-shot learning · Domain adaptation · Pretraining · Finetuning

ML & Engineering

Python · PyTorch · HuggingFace Transformers · NumPy · Pandas · Bash · Slurm · Git

Languages

English (native) · Farsi (fluent)

AWARDS

Summer Research Fellowship - \$6000	Summer 2025
Outstanding Research Award - \$500	AY 2022-2023
Ralph J. Slutz Student Excellence Award - \$1k	Fall 2021
Departmental Publication Recognition - \$200	Fall 2021
Dean's Graduate Assistantship - \$11.6k	AY 2020-2021